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Lead Developer

Planning Inspectorate

Apply before 11:55 pm on Tuesday 27th October 2026

Planning Inspectorate

Reference number

485248

Salary

£60,762

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Grade 7

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

PINS - Corporate Services

Type of role

Digital

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Bristol

About the job

Job summary

This is an opportunity to shape the delivery of digital services that have a real impact on users across England. You'll help drive innovation, influence

technical decision-making and support the development of modern, user centred solutions at scale.

Working in a collaborative multidisciplinary environment, you'll contribute to complex and rewarding projects while helping to develop others through coaching and mentoring. We encourage continuous learning, knowledge sharing and professional development, giving you the opportunity to grow your expertise and career.

We're committed to creating an inclusive workplace where everyone feels valued, supported and able to thrive. In return, you'll benefit from flexible working, a strong focus on wellbeing, ongoing learning and development opportunities, and the chance to influence the future of digital services.

The Planning Inspectorate has a long and proud history in ensuring a fair planning system for England. The work we do has a significant impact on people s lives, the communities where they live and the economy.

We want our colleagues to be able to work more flexibly and more collaboratively, exploring new and innovative ways to improve the way we provide services.

For further information on the Planning Inspectorate, please visit our careers page at Civil Service Careers

Job description

You'll provide technical leadership to support the delivery of secure, scalable and user-centred digital services. Working with multidisciplinary teams and a range of stakeholders, you'll help shape technical solutions, promote modern software engineering practices and ensure the delivery of high quality software.

Alongside leading technical delivery, you'll coach and support team members, contribute to planning and prioritisation activities, and help foster a collaborative and inclusive culture. You'll also play a key role in maintaining

technical standards, driving continuous improvement and supporting successful outcomes for users and the organisation.

These roles attract a DDaT allowance, for details please see the section marked Salary.

Salary

New entrants to the Civil Service are expected to start on the minimum of the pay band. Internal rules apply to existing Civil Servants, i.e. level transfers move on current salary or the pay range minimum, transfers on promotion move to new pay range minimum or receive 10% increase. Either case is determined by whichever is the highest.

Salary for the Grade 7 role is £60,762 plus a DDAT allowance of up to £20,756 based on Capability and base salary.

Working hours:

Standard working week is 37 hours, part time at 30 hours or above, flexible working hours policy available.

Office Attendance

This role is contractually based at our office in Bristol, 10-minute walk from Temple Meads train station. We recognise and value the mutual benefits of hybrid working and have a flexible approach to in person attendance, which can vary dependent on the requirements of individual business units - the details of which can be discussed with candidates if invited to attend an interview. Excitingly, we're relocating to a brand new office in December, while maintaining excellent transport links with Bristol Temple Meads station still just a 10 minute walk away.

Person specification

We will assess your application against the Essential Criteria listed:

Essential Criteria

Experience of building scalable, secure web applications (preferably in Azure), with detailed knowledge of server-side JavaScript programming or other modern languages.

Applying agile development methodologies, software design patterns, continuous integration, test-driven development and version control practices.

Experience of developing and working with RESTful APIs.

Experience of leading and mentoring development teams, promoting good software engineering practices and the delivery of high quality, well tested software.

Keeping up to date with emerging technologies and applying new programming tools and techniques to solve business and technical challenges.

Proven experience of balancing multiple priorities, working effectively in ambiguous environments, and identifying, diagnosing and resolving software faults.

For guidance on how to structure your application please visit: **About the application process , Civil Service Careers**

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Leadership

Changing and Improving

Delivering at Pace

Developing Self and Others

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Baseline technical knowledge

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £60,762, Planning Inspectorate contributes £17,602 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides (opens in a new window).

Flexible working options, including flexi-time, part-time, compressed hours and home working if suitable for the role.

A working culture which encourages inclusion and diversity.

25 days annual leave increasing by 1 day per year up to 30 days after 5 years, plus 1 privilege day to mark the King s birthday. In addition to the normal bank holidays.

Generous family friendly policies.

Fast and modern IT kit which utilises Windows 11 and Microsoft 365, enabling seamless working from home and collaboration across teams.

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using Success Profiles (opens in a new window), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Application

Complete the online application form on Civil Service Jobs which requires the following information:

A CV: The CV section lets you share your job history. List your jobs, how long you worked at each, and briefly describe your roles and duties. Make sure to show how your experience matches the essential criteria of the job you're applying for. Type or paste this information into the 'Employment History' box in the online application. You can't attach your CV.

A Personal Statement (1000 words max): The personal statement lets you explain why you're a good fit for the job in more detail. Use it to show how you meet the essential criteria listed in our advert and connect your answers to the Success Profile elements we're looking for.

If there are many applications, we might use a lead sift. This means we'll first check if you meet the key requirement listed below. If you don't, we won't review the rest of your application.

Experience of leading and mentoring development teams, promoting good software engineering practices and the delivery of high quality, well tested software.

All shortlisted candidates will be advised of the outcome shortly afterwards.

Interview

If you are shortlisted, you will:

Be asked to attend an interview to have a more in-depth discussion about your experience and suitability for the role

Interviews will be a blend of behaviour, strength, experience and technical questions

Complete a short test at interview stage

Candidates who pass the shortlist stage will receive full assessment details with their interview invitations.

Other Information

Shortlist Date: w/c 28th October 2026

Interview Date: w/c 2nd November 2026

Interviews will be held remotely using MS Teams. The interview will not be recorded or retained, other than usual interview protocol and in line with Civil Service Jobs privacy notice.

Reserve list

A reserve list may be held for a period of 9 months from which further appointments can be made.

Future Matches

Candidates who demonstrate strong potential and future readiness but score just below the required level at interview may be considered for alternative positions. These roles may be at a lower grade but align with their skills and offer opportunities for growth.

We encourage all candidates to make themselves familiar with the role and what we will be assessing you against which is detailed in the Person Specification.

ID and Documents

If the job needs specific qualifications or memberships and you get the job, you'll need to send scanned or photographed images of them before you start.

We must check that any successful candidates are allowed to work for the Civil Service before we employ them. If successful, you will be asked to do a right to work check using identity document validation technology (IDVT) through the services of an Identity Service Provider (IDSP), Civil Service Jobs. If we are unable to confirm your right to work and through the IDVT we will need to do a manual right to work check using original documents with you in person.

Visa Sponsorship

The Planning Inspectorate cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates, we do not hold a Visa sponsorship licence.

Disability Confident Interview scheme/Reasonable Adjustments

The Civil Service values diversity and offers equal opportunities. We have a Disability Confident Interview scheme for candidates with disabilities who meet the job's minimum criteria. We will also provide reasonable adjustments to all where possible. For more information please see Reasonable Adjustments , Civil Service Careers.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Adam Thompson

Email : PINS.Recruitment@planninginspectorate.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : PINS.Recruitment@planninginspectorate.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact in the first instance: The Vacancy Manager via the Recruitment Team (PINS.Recruitment@planninginspectorate.gov.uk).

If you are not satisfied with the response, you receive you should then contact, Chief People Officer, via the Recruitment Team (PINS.Recruitment@planninginspectorate.gov.uk).

If you are still not satisfied with the response you receive from the Planning Inspectorate, you can contact the Office of the Civil Service Commission. https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/recruitment/recruitment-complaints/

Civil Service Commission

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